

Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5

Best flip phone of 2023

It is the season of foldable and we have seen a few groundbreaking launches this year.

I remember using the Motorola Razr 40 Ultra and after absolutely loving everything about the device, I still didn't feel very confident when I used the Moto Razr 40 Ultra. That was largely because of the hinge not being or feeling as sturdy as one would like. Then came along the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 5, which, from the first time I held it, made me feel confident about holding it, using it, opening it, and closing it.

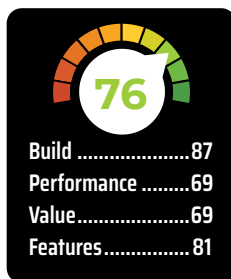
The fit and finish, along with newer implementations like the large 3.4-inch AMOLED display, put just one thought in my head - "is the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5 the best modern flip smartphone to have ever landed?" Let's find:

DESIGN

From the very first time I held it, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5 just felt more refined, more complete. First things first - the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5 closes completely shut. This time around, there is no gap in between the two flaps of the smartphone, which is probably the best design update of this year. The hinge also feels super smooth and sturdy and you can hold the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5 in any position, in order to use the smartphone's camera or other features in the "flex mode."

The second-best design element is of course, the outer or the cover display. The 3.4-inch AMOLED display gives the Flip 5 its own distinct look apart from enhancing the usability. When opened, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5 has a proportionate design, but like last year, the aspect ratio is more towards a taller orientation, making the smartphone very hard to use with one hand. Furthermore, I wasn't able to notice

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any significant difference in the crease so Samsung's new mechanism hasn't really made any major difference in terms of how prominent the crease on the display is.

One thing I liked about the smartphone when it's open is how sturdy the smartphone feels. The super premium in-hand feel is worth mentioning here. At the back, we get a simple glass panel.

Overall, this is the biggest design update on the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip series and Samsung's experiment with the larger outer display and a more boxy design has worked quite well.

DISPLAY

Coming to the display, first I'm going to talk about the cover display. It does a lot. We get the ability to take calls, messages, run apps like WhatsApp, Netflix, and YouTube by default, and there is a slew of

widgets that you can make use of. Further, with Samsung's Good Lock app, users can also run all apps on the cover display.

The display isn't as smooth as the one on the Moto Razr 40 Ultra, which is a 144Hz panel, but it does pretty much everything the display on the Motorola does, just not natively since we need the Good Lock app to run more apps on this cover display. In terms of brightness and colours, this display felt adequately bright and colour accurate for all kinds of environments and users.

It is the 6.7-inch main display where the colour accuracy matters and here, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5's display looks quite saturated. We compared the display against some of the smartphones like the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra or the iPhone 14 and the Galaxy Z Flip 5 was a bit too vibrant and saturated as compared to these two. Now, this is something a lot of people out there will prefer, but the colour accuracy on this panel isn't as good as some of the options in the market.

Coming to brightness and responsiveness, the sunlight visibility is as good as indoor visibility, and I never felt any lack while using both the outer and inside display in bright outdoors. I also tested the brightness using a Lux Meter, and on a plain white screen, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 showed a maximum luminance of 831 nits. This is brilliant.

One thing I wish Samsung could have implemented is giving us a higher refresh rate on the outer display, which is limited to just 60Hz, making it feel a bit slow as compared to the main display. I was coming from the Moto Razr 40 Ultra to the Samsung, and the Moto Razr 40 Ultra uses a 144Hz refresh rate so the Galaxy Z Flip5 made me wish that Samsung should have put at least a 90Hz display.

PERFORMANCE

Now, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 is today's flagship and comes with the latest bleeding edge specs. As expected, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 is a brilliant performer. The smartphone put up very good scores. On AnTuTu, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 put out a score of 1,125,032